

## Cheng Xiao, Ph.D.

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<https://chengxiaocx.github.io>  
*Curriculum Vitae* (updated: Sep 24, 2026)

### Academic positions

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| 2026–present | Postdoctoral Fellow, Feilong Lab, Department of Psychology, University of South Carolina.                           |
| 2023–2025    | Graduate Research Assistant, Desai Lab and Aging Brain Cohort, University of South Carolina.                        |
| 2019–2023    | Graduate Teaching Assistant (Instructor of Record), Linguistics and Chinese Programs, University of South Carolina. |

### Education

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| 2019–2025 | <b>Ph.D.</b> , Linguistics, University of South Carolina.            |
| 2013–2016 | <b>M.A.</b> , Linguistics and Applied Linguistics, Wuhan University. |
| 2009–2013 | <b>B.A.</b> , Humanities, Wuhan University.                          |
| 2010–2013 | <b>B.Ec.</b> , Finance, Wuhan University.                            |

### Grants, awards and fellowships

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| 2023–2025  | NSF Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant (Ling-DDRIG: BCS-2234914), National Science Foundation, USD 17,780.                     |
| 2024       | Dr. Richard Walker Memorial Endowed Fellowship, Walker Institute of International and Area Studies, University of South Carolina, USD 5,000. |
| 2023       | Paula Menyuk Travel Award (merit-based), the 48 <sup>th</sup> Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD 48), USD 385.      |
| 2023       | Discover USC Graduate Student Poster Award winner, University of South Carolina.                                                             |
| 2022–2023  | USC SPARC Graduate Research Grant, University of South Carolina, USD 4,938.                                                                  |
| 2023, 2025 | Society for Human Sentence Processing Student Travel Award. USD 400, USD 375.                                                                |

- 2021, 2024     Linguistics Program Graduate Student Summer Research Award, University of South Carolina, USD 600, USD 500.
- 2020-2021     Graduate Teaching Resource Development Award (for enrichment of Elementary and Advanced Mandarin Chinese courses), Center for Teaching Excellence, University of South Carolina, USD 800.
- 2013–2016     Outstanding Graduate Student Fellowship, Wuhan University, tuition & living expenses.
- 2011            Best Undergraduate Student Paper Award winner, College of Chinese Language and Literature, Wuhan University.
- 2009–2013     Outstanding Undergraduate Student Award, Wuhan University, RMB 3,200.

## Publications

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### Refereed papers

- Xiao, C.**, Liu, J., Shinkareva, S.V., Yang, X. and Desai, R.H. (2026). Knowing and feeling: The role of semantic valence in emotional prosody perception for L2 Chinese learners. *Bilingualism: Language and Cognition*, 1–12.  
<https://doi.org/10.1017/S1366728926101813>
- Xiao, C.**, Arheix-Parras, S., Riccardi, N., Johari, K., Desai, R.H. (2026). Anterior Temporal Lobe Mediates Associative and Taxonomic Neighborhood Effects in Lexical Processing. *Cortex*, 203(10), 252-265. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cortex.2026.06.026>
- Arheix-Parras, S., **Xiao, C.**, Crouse, C., Riccardi, N., Johari, K., Desai, R.H. (2026). The Role of the Anterior Temporal Lobe in Reading: an HD-tDCS Study. *Neurobiology of Language*.  
<https://doi.org/10.1162/NOL.a.266>
- Xiao, C.** (2025). *The Processing of Emotional Prosody and Semantics in Native and Non-Native Chinese Speakers*. (Doctoral dissertation). Retrieved from  
<https://scholarcommons.sc.edu/etd/8628>
- Xiao, C.**, & Liu, J. (2026). The perception of emotional prosody in Mandarin Chinese words and sentences. *Second Language Research*, 42(1), 3-30.  
<https://doi.org/10.1177/02676583241286748>
- Xiao, C.**, & Liu, J. (2025). Semantic effects on the perception of emotional prosody in native and non-native Chinese speakers. *Cognition and Emotion*, 39(7), 1542–1552.  
<https://doi.org/10.1080/02699931.2024.2371088>
- Wang, B. X., Chen, S., Zhou, F., Liu, J., **Xiao, C.**, Chan, A., & Tang, T. (2024). English Prosodic Focus Marking by Cantonese Trilingual Children with and without Autism Spectrum Disorder. *Journal of Speech, Language, and Hearing Research*, 67(3), 782-801. [https://doi.org/10.1044/2023\\_JSLHR-23-00508](https://doi.org/10.1044/2023_JSLHR-23-00508)
- Liu, J., & **Xiao, C.** (2021). Tone Category Learning Should Serve Tone Word Learning: An Experiment of Integrating Pronunciation Teaching in L2 Chinese Curriculum. In Edited Volume *The Acquisition of Chinese as a Second Language Pronunciation: Segments and*

*Prosody*. Edited by Yang, Chunsheng: Springer. [http://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-15-3809-4\\_6](http://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-15-3809-4_6)

### Work in progress

- Xiao, C.**, Liu, J., Zhang, Y., Lyu, W., Desai, R.H., Feilong, M. (under review). Brain Mechanisms of Lexicality in Bilingual Emotion Processing. Preprint, <https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.09.21.753217>
- Yang, X., Gao, C., **Xiao, C.**, Riccardi, N., Desai, R.H. (*in revision*). Multifaceted Neural Representation of Words in Naturalistic Language. Preprint, <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2601.13297>.
- Xiao, C.**, Liu, J., Yang, X., Feilong, M., Shinkareva, V. S., Desai, R.H. (manuscript available upon request). How does Semantics Interact with Emotional Prosody in the Bilingual Brain?
- Arheix-Parras, S. (co-first author), **Xiao, C.** (co-first author), Singh, S., Riccardi, N., Johari, K., Desai, R.H. (manuscript available upon request). Anterior Temporal Stimulation Reveals Modality-specific Lexical Processing.
- Xiao, C.**, Arheix-Parras, S., Desai, R.H., Fridriksson, J., Feilong, M. (in preparation). The Effects of Emotional Prosody on Lexico-semantic Processing in Neurotypical Adults and Individuals with Post-stroke Aphasia.

### Educational publications

- Luo, H., Zhao, S., Luo, J., Tan, Xin., Ruan, G., Chen, Y., ..., **Xiao, C.**, ..., & Zhu, Y. (2018). *Comprehensive Dictionary of Chinese Poetry Rhythms* 中华诗韵大辞典, Zhonghua Book Company 中华书局, ISBN 978-7101129779.
- Tang, C., Luo, X., Zhan, Y., Li, H., Mo, Y., Zhang, Wen., Sun, D., Zhang, Xue., Liu, Y., **Xiao, C.**, Yuan, Yu., & Xin, Wen. (2017). *Chinese Characters and Calligraphy* (Guangdong province calligraphy textbook series, Book 3 & 4) 写字课 (三) (四), Guangdong Education Publishing House 广东教育出版社, ISBN 978-7554815625. ISBN 978-7554815632.

### Presentations

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#### Invited talks

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| 2025 | Language and Emotion in L1 and L2 Brain, <i>Second Language Acquisition Reading Group at the University of South Carolina</i> , Columbia, SC, February 20.                                                          |
| 2024 | The Perception of Emotional Prosody in L2 Chinese Learners, <i>Special Session on Second Language Acquisition at the Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia</i> (LCUGA 2024), Athens, GA, February 17. |

## Conference presentations

- 2026 Distinct neural responses to words and pseudowords in emotional prosody perception between native and non-native speakers, *SNL 2026*, October 2.
- 2026 How does Semantics Interact with Emotional Prosody in the Bilingual Brain, *SNL 2026*, September 30.
- 2026 How does Semantics Interact with Emotional Prosody in the Bilingual Brain, *CogSci 2026*, virtual presentation, July 23.
- 2025 Neural Processing of Emotional Prosody in Native and Non-native Chinese Speakers, *38<sup>th</sup> Annual Human Sentence Processing Conference (HSP 38)*, College Park, MD, March 28.
- 2024 Semantic Neighborhood Effects with Anterior Temporal Lobe Stimulation, *Society for the Neurobiology of Language 16<sup>th</sup> Annual Meeting (SNL 2024)*, Brisbane, Australia, October 26.
- 2024 The Perception of Emotional Prosody in Novice and Advanced L2 Chinese Learners, *37<sup>th</sup> Annual Human Sentence Processing Conference (HSP 37)*, Ann Arbor, MI, May 16.
- 2024 Knowing is Feeling: The Role of Semantic Valence in Emotional Prosody Perception for L2 Chinese Learners, *2024 GSLING Student Research Symposium at the University of South Carolina*, Columbia, SC, April 13.
- 2023 Semantic Effects on the Perception of Emotional Prosody in Mandarin Chinese: Facilitation for L1 Speakers versus Interference for L2 Learners, *48<sup>th</sup> Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD 48)*, Boston, MA, November 4.
- 2023 The Emotional Prosody Perception of Native Speakers and L2 Learners: An Examination of Semantic Congruence Effect, *Florida Psycholinguistics Meeting 2023 (FPM 2023)*, Gainesville, FL, October 21.
- 2023 What You Say vs. How You Say It: The Semantic Effect on the Perception of Emotional Prosody in Mandarin Chinese Words and Sentence, *Discover USC 2023 at the University of South Carolina*, Columbia, SC, April 21.
- 2023 The Semantic Effect on the Perception of Emotional Prosody in Mandarin Chinese, *2023 GSLING Student Research Symposium at the University of South Carolina*, Columbia, SC, April 8.
- 2023 The Semantic Effect on the Perception of Emotional Prosody in Mandarin Chinese Words and Sentences, *Conference of the Institute for Mind and Brain at the University of South Carolina 2023*, Columbia, SC, March 17.
- 2023 Bridging Sound and Meaning: The Semantic Effect on the Perception of Emotional Prosody in Mandarin Chinese, *36<sup>th</sup> Annual Human Sentence Processing Conference (HSP 36)*, Pittsburgh, PA, March 10.

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| 2022 | The Perception of Emotional Prosody in Mandarin Chinese Words and Sentences, <i>2022 GSLING Student Research Symposium at the University of South Carolina</i> , Columbia, SC, March 18.               |
| 2022 | The Perception of Emotional Prosody in Mandarin Chinese, <i>96<sup>th</sup> Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA 96)</i> , Washington, DC, January 8.                              |
| 2021 | The Effect of Language Experience on the Perception of Emotional Prosody in Mandarin Chinese, <i>1<sup>st</sup> International Conference on Tone and Intonation</i> , Sonderborg, Denmark, December 8. |
| 2018 | The Mini-corpus Analysis of the Language of Autistic Children, <i>4<sup>th</sup> Corpus Linguistics Conference in China</i> , Wuhan, China, June 2.                                                    |
| 2018 | Inquiry into the Language Acquisition of Autistic Children, <i>1<sup>st</sup> Neurolinguistics Conference in China</i> , Xuzhou, China, July 1.                                                        |

## Teaching experience

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| 2023-2024 | <b>Invited Guest Lecturer</b> , Linguistics Program, University of South Carolina<br>LING 474/PSYC 474: Cognitive and Social Aspects of Bilingualism (on accent)<br>LING 300/PSYC 300: Introduction to Language Sciences (on phonetics)                                                                                                                                              |
| 2022-2023 | <b>Instructor of Record</b> , Linguistics Program, University of South Carolina<br>LING 301/ENGL 389: The English Language<br>LING 101: Introduction to Language                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 2019-2022 | <b>Instructor of Record</b> , Department of Languages, Literatures and Cultures, University of South Carolina<br>CHIN 322: Advanced Mandarin Chinese II<br>CHIN 321: Advanced Mandarin Chinese I<br>CHIN 222: Intermediate Mandarin Chinese II<br>CHIN 221: Intermediate Mandarin Chinese I<br>CHIN 122: Basic Proficiency Mandarin Chinese<br>CHIN 121: Elementary Mandarin Chinese |
| 2019-2020 | <b>ESL Tutor</b> , University of South Carolina                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

## Ad-hoc reviewing

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| Journal    | <i>Bilingualism: Language and Cognition</i> , <i>Second Language Research</i> , <i>Scientific Reports</i> , <i>PLOS One</i> |
| Conference | Discover USC 2024, Psychology and Neuroscience Section.                                                                     |

## Service

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| 2023-2025 | Graduate Fellowship Peer Mentor, for the National Fellowship office at the University of South Carolina.                                                  |
| 2024      | Graduate Enrichment Committee Member, for the Linguistics Program at the University of South Carolina.                                                    |
| 2023      | Professional Development Workshop Leader, <i>Creating Research Posters 101</i> for GSLING Student Research Symposium at the University of South Carolina. |
| 2020-2021 | Course Module Designer, Prosodic-enhanced course module for the Chinese Program and Center for Teaching Excellence at the University of South Carolina.   |

## Skills

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| <b>Tools</b>     | AFNI, Audacity, E-Prime, Gorilla, MATLAB, neuroboros, Praat, Python, Qualtrics, R, Unix/Linux                                                                                                           |
| <b>Methods</b>   | Behavioral measures, fMRI (task design, acquisition, preprocessing, GLM, hyperalignment, RSA), HD-tDCS (task design, administration, behavioral analysis, mixed-effect modeling), HPC/cluster computing |
| <b>Languages</b> | English, Mandarin Chinese (native), Xiang Chinese (native)                                                                                                                                              |

## Memberships

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Society for the Neurobiology of Language  
Society for Neuroscience  
Society for Human Sentence Processing

## References

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